


**Figure 3.1 Illustration of power.**

[**Source:** Adapted from Theodore A. Couloumbis and James H. Wolfe][10]

From the realist's perspective, international politics becomes nothing but an incessant struggle for power. As its chief proponent, Hans J. Morgenthau[11] pointed out in his classic text, *Politics Among Nations*, in the section entitled "International Politics as a Struggle for Power": "International politics like all politics is a struggle for power. Whatever the ultimate aims of international politics, power is the immediate aim". To him power "may comprise anything that establishes and maintains control of man over man [and it] covers all social relationships which serve that end, from physical violence to the most subtle psychological ties by which one mind controls another".

According to Organski[12], power is "part of a relationship between individuals or groups of individuals" and cannot therefore be "disentangled from the rest of the relationship but it is influenced by it and changes with it. For, power is that part of relationship in which each party is able to influence the behaviour of the other, and almost any tie between two nations may be utilized in this fashion". Power is, thus, the ability to influence the behaviour of others in accordance with one's ends. Unless a nation can do this, even if it is large, wealthy, or even great, it cannot become powerful.

Padelford and Lincoln[13] define national power "as the sum total of the strength and capabilities of a state harnessed and applied to the advancement of its national interests and the attainment of its national objectives".

As Ebenstein (1948) puts national power more than the sum total of certain quantitative factors, it is "The alliance potential of a nation, its civic devotion, the flexibility of its institutions, its technical know-how, its capacity to endure privations". These may be referred to as a few